

Word family: **excuse / excuses / excused / excusing / excusable / inexcusable**

Base word: excuse

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

* **excuse** (n.) — 藉口；理由

* **excuse** (v.) — 原諒；寬恕；准許離開；免除

* **excused** (adj./participle) — 獲准離開的；獲免除的；被原諒的

* **excusable** (adj.) — 可原諒的；情有可原的

* **inexcusable** (adj.) — 不可原諒的；無可辯解的

* **excuse me** — 對不起；勞駕；請問；借過

* **make an excuse** — 找藉口

* **have an excuse** — 有理由 / 藉口

* **no excuse for** — 沒有理由為.....開脫

* **excuse someone from** — 免除某人.....

* **be excused from** — 獲免除.....

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **make an excuse**

* **make excuses**

* **weak excuse**

* **poor excuse**

* **reasonable excuse**

* **valid excuse**

* **excuse for something**

* **excuse for doing something**

* **no excuse for**

* **use something as an excuse**

* **that's no excuse**

* **excuse someone**

* **excuse someone's behaviour**

* **excuse someone from class**

* **be excused from duty**

* **excuse me**

* **if you'll excuse me**

* **excusable mistake**

* **inexcusable behaviour**

Meaning in this passage

> What I appreciated was that he did not try to sugar-coat it or make weak **excuses**.

Here, **excuses** means:

reasons given to avoid blame or responsibility, especially reasons that are not very convincing — 藉口；為自己開脫的理由

Kevin did not try to justify his behaviour by saying things like “I was tired” or “everyone was stressed” in order to reduce his responsibility.

中文翻譯：

我很欣賞的一點是，他沒有試圖輕描淡寫，也沒有找一些無力的**藉口**。

So here:

excuse = 為自己的錯誤或不當行為提供理由，尤其是為了減輕責任或責備

1. **excuse (藉口)** — 藉口；開脫理由

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> He did not make weak **excuses**.

他沒有找一些無力的**藉口**。

Practice 2

> Stop making **excuses** and take responsibility.

不要再找**藉口**，承擔責任吧。

Practice 3

> His explanation sounded more like an **excuse**.

他的解釋聽起來更像一個**藉口**。

MCQ-ready definition:

excuse = 為自己的錯誤、失敗或行為提供的理由，尤其是用來避免責任或責備

2. ****make an excuse — 找藉口；提出開脫理由****

Practice 1

> He ****made an excuse**** for being late.

他為遲到****找了個藉口****。

Practice 2

> She always ****makes excuses**** when something goes wrong.

每當事情出錯，她總會****找藉口****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****make an excuse = 提出一個理由來解釋或開脫自己的錯誤或行為****

3. ****make excuses — 不斷找藉口****

Plural often carries a more negative tone.

Practice 1

> Don't ****make excuses****.

不要****找藉口****。

Practice 2

> He kept ****making excuses**** instead of fixing the problem.

他沒有解決問題，反而一直****找藉口****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****make excuses = 反覆提出理由以避免承擔責任****

4. ****weak excuse — 無力的藉口；牽強理由****

This is the exact collocation in your passage.

Practice 1

> He didn't make any **weak excuses**.

他沒有找任何**牽強的藉口**。

Practice 2

> “I forgot” is a pretty **weak excuse**.

「我忘了」是一個很**無力的藉口**。

MCQ-ready definition:

weak excuse = 缺乏說服力、不能真正合理解釋行為的藉口

5. **poor excuse** — 很差 / 站不住腳的藉口

Practice 1

> That's a **poor excuse** for missing the deadline.

那是錯過截止日期的一個**很差的藉口**。

Practice 2

> Being tired is a **poor excuse** for treating people badly.

疲累並不是對人態度差的好理由，只是一個**站不住腳的藉口**。

MCQ-ready definition:

poor excuse = 不合理或說服力很低的藉口

6. **valid / reasonable excuse** — 合理理由；正當理由

Not every **excuse** is dishonest.

Practice 1

> Illness may be a **valid excuse** for absence.

生病可能是缺席的**合理理由**。

Practice 2

> She had a **reasonable excuse** for arriving late.

她遲到有一個**合理原因**。

MCQ-ready definition:

valid/reasonable excuse = 足以合理解釋某人未能做某事或做錯某事的正當理由

7. **excuse for something** — 某事的理由 / 藉口

Practice 1

> What's your **excuse for the delay**?

你對這次延誤有甚麼**解釋 / 藉口**？

Practice 2

> There was no good **excuse for his behaviour**.

他的行為沒有甚麼**合理理由**。

MCQ-ready definition:

excuse for X = 用來解釋或開脫 X 的理由

8. **excuse for doing something** — 為做某事找理由

Practice 1

> He had no **excuse for shouting at her**.

他沒有任何理由可以為向她大叫**開脫**。

Practice 2

> Stress is not always an **excuse for treating people badly**.

壓力並不總能成為對人態度差的**藉口**。

MCQ-ready definition:

excuse for doing X = 用來為做 X 辯解或減輕責任的理由

9. **no excuse for — 沒有理由；不能為……開脫**

Practice 1

> There is **no excuse for cheating**.

作弊是**沒有理由可以開脫的**。

Practice 2

> Being angry is **no excuse for insulting someone**.

生氣並不是侮辱別人的**藉口**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****no excuse for X = 沒有任何合理理由能為 X 辯護或開脫****

10. **That's no excuse. — 那不是理由；別拿這個當藉口**

Practice 1

> “I was tired.”

> “That's **no excuse**.”

「我很累。」

「那也**不是藉口**。」

Practice 2

> Everyone was under pressure, but that's **no excuse** for blaming you unfairly.

大家都有壓力，但這也**不能成為**不公平怪責你的**理由**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****That's no excuse = 那個理由不足以合理化某人的行為****

11. **use something as an excuse — 拿某事當藉口**

Practice 1

> He **used stress as an excuse** for losing his temper.

他**拿壓力當藉口**，為自己發脾氣開脫。

Practice 2

> Don't **use being busy as an excuse**.

不要**拿忙碌當藉口**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****use X as an excuse = 把 X 當成理由，以避免責任或合理化行為****

12. ****excuse (verb : 原諒 ; 寬恕) — 原諒 ; 諒解****

A major separate verb sense.

Practice 1

> Please ****excuse my mistake****.

請****原諒我的錯誤****。

Practice 2

> You'll have to ****excuse him****; he's had a difficult day.

你要****體諒他一下****，他今天很不好過。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****excuse someone/something = 原諒某人的錯誤、失禮或不當行為****

13. ****excuse someone's behaviour — 原諒 / 為某人的行為開脫****

This can have two shades.

Practice 1

> Nothing can ****excuse his behaviour****.

沒有甚麼可以****為他的行為開脫****。

Practice 2

> Stress may explain the behaviour, but it does not **excuse it**.

壓力可能解釋這種行為，但不能**令它變得可以接受 / 為它開脫**。

MCQ-ready definition:

excuse behaviour = 視某種行為為可原諒、可接受，或認為其責任可被減輕

14. **excuse someone for something — 原諒某人的某事**

Practice 1

> I can **excuse him for being late** once.

他偶爾遲到一次，我可以**原諒他**。

Practice 2

> She couldn't **excuse him for lying**.

她無法**原諒他說謊**。

MCQ-ready definition:

excuse someone for X = 因某件錯事而選擇原諒某人

15. **excuse (准許離開) — 讓某人先離開；准許退席**

Practice 1

> The teacher **excused me from class early**.

老師准許我**提早離開課堂**。

Practice 2

> Please **excuse me** for a moment.

請**容我離開一下 / 失陪一下**。

MCQ-ready definition:

excuse someone = 准許某人離開某場合或不再參與當下活動

16. **be excused — 獲准離開**

Practice 1

> May I **be excused**?

我可以**先離開嗎 / 失陪嗎**?

Practice 2

> Students may **be excused** after finishing the test.

學生完成測驗後可以**獲准離開**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be excused = 獲准離開、退出或不再參與某項活動

17. **excuse someone from something — 免除某人某項責任**

A major formal use.

Practice 1

> The doctor **excused him from physical activity**.

醫生**免除他參加體能活動**。

Practice 2

> She was **excused from the meeting**.

她**獲准不用出席會議**。

MCQ-ready definition:

excuse someone from X = 正式允許某人不用參與、執行或承擔 X

18. **be excused from duty / class — 獲免除職責 / 課堂**

Practice 1

> He was **excused from duty** for medical reasons.

他因健康理由**獲免除職務**。

Practice 2

> She was **excused from class** that afternoon.

她那天下午**獲准不用上課**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be excused from X = 因合理原因獲正式批准不參與 X

19. **Excuse me.** (引起注意) — 勞駕；請問

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 1

> **Excuse me**, where is the station?

請問 / 勞駕，車站在哪裏？

Practice 2

> **Excuse me**, could you help me?

不好意思 / 請問，你可以幫我嗎？

MCQ-ready definition:

Excuse me = 禮貌地引起陌生人注意或開始向別人提出問題

20. **Excuse me.** (借過) — 不好意思；借過

Practice 1

> **Excuse me**, can I get past?

不好意思，借過一下。

Practice 2

> **Excuse me**, you're blocking the door.

不好意思，你擋住門口了。

MCQ-ready definition:

Excuse me = 禮貌地要求別人讓路或容許自己經過

21. **Excuse me. (小失禮後道歉) — 不好意思；失禮了**

Practice 1

> **Excuse me**, I didn't mean to interrupt.

不好意思，我不是故意打斷你的。

Practice 2

> **Excuse me** for reaching across you.

伸手越過你面前，**不好意思**。

MCQ-ready definition:

Excuse me = 對輕微失禮、打擾或身體上的小冒犯表示禮貌歉意

22. **Excuse me? (沒聽清楚) — 不好意思？可以再說一次嗎？**

Practice 1

> "The meeting starts at six."

> "***Excuse me?*"

「會議六點開始。」

「**不好意思？可以再說一次嗎？**」

Practice 2

> **Excuse me?** I didn't hear the last part.

不好意思？我沒聽清楚最後那部分。

MCQ-ready definition:

Excuse me? = 禮貌表示沒有聽清楚，要求對方重複

23. **Excuse me? (表示驚訝 / 不滿) — 你說甚麼? **

Tone-sensitive.

Practice 1

> “You caused the whole problem.”

> “**Excuse me?**”

「整件事都是你造成的。」

「**你說甚麼? **」

Practice 2

> **Excuse me?** That's not what happened.

**你說甚麼? **事情根本不是那樣。

MCQ-ready definition:

Excuse me? = 用帶驚訝或不滿的語氣質疑對方剛才的說話

24. **If you'll excuse me — 失陪；容我離開**

Practice 1

> **If you'll excuse me**, I need to make a phone call.

失陪一下，我需要打個電話。

Practice 2

> **If you'll excuse me**, I should get back to work.

不好意思，我先失陪了，我要回去工作。

MCQ-ready definition:

if you'll excuse me = 禮貌表示自己準備離開、暫時退出或做另一件事

25. **excusable — 情有可原的；可原諒的**

Practice 1

> His mistake was **excusable**.

他的錯誤是**情有可原的**。

Practice 2

> A small mistake under those circumstances is **excusable**.

在那種情況下犯一個小錯誤是**可以原諒的**。

MCQ-ready definition:

excusable = 有足夠理由令人願意原諒或理解的

26. **excusable mistake — 情有可原的錯誤**

Practice 1

> It was an **excusable mistake**.

那是一個**情有可原的錯誤**。

Practice 2

> Confusing the two names was probably **excusable**.

把兩個名字搞混大概是**可以理解和原諒的**。

MCQ-ready definition:

excusable mistake = 因情況特殊、後果輕微等而可被原諒的錯誤

27. **inexcusable — 不可原諒的；無可辯解的**

Practice 1

> His behaviour was **inexcusable**.

他的行為**不可原諒**。

Practice 2

> Publicly humiliating someone without checking the facts is **inexcusable**.

未查清事實便當眾羞辱別人是**無可辯解的**。

MCQ-ready definition:

inexcusable = 嚴重或錯誤到沒有合理理由可以辯解或原諒的

28. **inexcusable behaviour / mistake** — 不可原諒的行為 / 錯誤

Practice 1

> The delay was unfortunate, but the rude response was **inexcusable**.

延誤很可惜，但粗魯的回應是**不可接受、無可辯解的**。

Practice 2

> That was an **inexcusable error**.

那是一個**無法開脫的錯誤**。

MCQ-ready definition:

inexcusable X = 沒有任何合理理由能夠為 X 開脫

Important distinction 1: **excuse vs reason**

This is crucial.

reason

neutral explanation of why something happened.

excuse

often suggests a reason used to **avoid blame or responsibility**.

> The reason I was late was that the train broke down.

我遲到的原因是火車故障。

> He gave a weak excuse for being late.

他為遲到找了個無力的藉口。

So:

every excuse is a reason offered

but

not every reason is an excuse

Important distinction 2: **excuse vs explanation**

This is especially relevant to your passage.

explanation

helps us understand what happened.

excuse

tries to justify or reduce responsibility.

Kevin says:

> stress had got the better of him

That can function as an **explanation**.

But because he still accepts responsibility, it does not have to be an **excuse**.

This is why the passage works well:

explanation + responsibility ≠ excuse

Important distinction 3: **excuse vs apology**

apology

expresses regret.

excuse

gives a reason for the behavior.

> I'm sorry I embarrassed you.

= apology

> I was tired, so I couldn't help it.

= possibly an excuse

A sincere apology can include an explanation without becoming an excuse.

Important distinction 4: **excuse vs justification**

excuse

often reduces blame.

justification

argues that the action was actually right, reasonable, or necessary.

> Stress is an excuse.

壓力是拿來開脫的理由。

> Self-defence may be a justification.

自衛可能是正當理由。

Important distinction 5: **excuse vs alibi**

excuse

reason offered for behaviour/failure.

alibi

evidence or claim that someone was somewhere else when a crime happened.

They are not interchangeable.

Important distinction 6: ****weak excuse vs valid excuse****

****weak excuse****

not convincing.

****valid excuse****

genuinely reasonable.

So ****excuse**** is not automatically dishonest.

Context and adjective matter.

Important distinction 7: ****make excuses vs explain yourself****

****make excuses****

often defensive and responsibility-avoiding.

****explain yourself****

give an account of why you acted as you did.

You can explain yourself honestly without making excuses.

Important distinction 8: ****excuse someone vs forgive someone****

****excuse****

often means overlook a relatively minor fault or accept a reason.

****forgive****

usually deeper emotional release of blame or resentment.

> Please excuse the delay.

請見諒延誤。

> I forgive you.

我原諒你。

They overlap, but ****forgive**** is often more personal and emotionally significant.

Important distinction 9: ****excuse behaviour vs approve behaviour****

If you ****excuse**** behaviour, you may accept that there were mitigating reasons.

That does not necessarily mean you think the behaviour was good.

So:

> excuse ≠ approve

Important distinction 10: ****excuse someone from X vs excuse someone for X****

Preposition changes the meaning.

****excuse someone from X****

免除某人參與 X

> excuse her from class

> 准她不用上課

****excuse someone for X****

原諒某人做了 X

> excuse her for being late

> 原諒她遲到

Excellent grammar distinction.

Important distinction 11: ****Excuse me vs I'm sorry****

****Excuse me****

often before/minor interruption:

- * getting attention
- * passing someone
- * interrupting

I'm sorry

more direct apology for something already done or more serious.

> Excuse me, can I get past?

借過一下。

> I'm sorry I hurt you.

對不起，我傷害了你。

Important distinction 12: **Excuse me? can have opposite tones**

Polite clarification

> Excuse me?

不好意思，可以再說一次嗎？

Offended challenge

> Excuse me?!

你說甚麼？！

Intonation is crucial.

Important distinction 13: **excusable vs understandable**

understandable

easy to understand why it happened.

excusable

deserving forgiveness.

A behavior can be understandable but still not excusable.

For example:

> His stress was understandable, but publicly blaming someone without checking was not necessarily excusable.

That distinction is extremely useful.

Important distinction 14: ****inexcusable vs unforgivable****

****inexcusable****

no reasonable justification exists.

****unforgivable****

so serious that forgiveness feels impossible.

****Unforgivable**** is usually emotionally stronger.

Important distinction 15: ****no excuse for vs because of****

Compare:

> He shouted because of stress.

describes cause.

> Stress is no excuse for shouting.

judges that the cause does not justify the action.

Cause and excuse are not the same thing.

Family-extension note

****Excuse**** has several major branches:

1. ****noun: reason used to reduce blame****

- * make an excuse
- * weak excuse
- * valid excuse

2. ****verb: forgive / overlook****

- * excuse my mistake
- * excuse someone's behaviour

3. ****verb: release from obligation****

- * excuse someone from class
- * be excused from duty

4. ****politeness formula****

- * Excuse me.
- * Excuse me?
- * If you'll excuse me.

5. ****judgment of acceptability****

- * excusable
- * inexcusable

The central semantic link is:

****remove or reduce blame / obligation****

That can mean:

- * give a reason to reduce blame,
- * forgive a fault,
- * release someone from a duty,
- * politely ask someone to overlook a minor interruption.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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excuse (noun)	藉口；理由	reason reducing blame	
make an excuse	找藉口	give defensive reason	
make excuses	不斷找藉口	avoid responsibility	
weak excuse	無力的藉口	unconvincing reason	
poor excuse	很差的藉口	weak justification	
valid excuse	合理理由	acceptable reason	
reasonable excuse	正當理由	reasonable explanation	
excuse for X	為 X 的藉口	reason	
no excuse for X	沒理由為 X 開脫	not justified	
use X as an excuse	拿 X 當藉口	shift responsibility	
excuse (verb)	原諒；諒解	overlook fault	
excuse behaviour	為行為開脫 / 原諒	reduce blame	
excuse someone for X	原諒某人 X	forgiveness	
excuse someone from X	免除某人 X	release obligation	
be excused	獲准離開	permission to leave	
be excused from duty	獲免除職務	exemption	
Excuse me	不好意思 / 勞駕 / 請問	polite attention/apology	
Excuse me?	請再說一次 / 你說甚麼？	clarification/challenge	
If you'll excuse me	失陪	polite departure	
excusable	情有可原的	forgivable	
inexcusable	不可原諒的；無可辯解的	no acceptable excuse	

For your original sentence

> What I appreciated was that he did not try to sugar-coat it or make weak **excuses**.

Here:

excuses = 為了減輕自己責任而提出、但並不真正有說服力的理由

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 我很欣賞的一點是，他沒有試圖輕描淡寫，也沒有找一些**無力的藉口**。

The key contrast is:

> **explanation** = 解釋事情為甚麼發生

> **excuse** = 用理由替自己開脫

> **apology** = 承認傷害並表示歉意

Kevin's response is strong precisely because he **explains** the stress, but does not use it as an **excuse**, and still gives a proper **apology**.